

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 606

By Cepicky

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend the Columbia State
Chargers men's basketball team upon an
outstanding 2024-2025 season.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that this General Assembly should salute those student athletes who, through their extraordinary efforts, have distinguished themselves as true champions of whom we can all be proud; and

WHEREAS, one such exemplary group of young men is the Chargers men's basketball team of Columbia State Community College, whose members have proven themselves to be the fiercest of competitors and truly worthy of admiration by posting an excellent 27-5 record this season and winning three titles, the Tennessee Community College Athletic Association (TCCAA) regular season championship with 15 wins; the TCCAA Tournament championship; and the Appalachian District championship; and

WHEREAS, Mahki Wright was honored as the TCCAA Tournament's Most Valuable Player, and he and teammate Thaddeus Johnson were named to the All-TCCAA First Team; and

WHEREAS, in Appalachian District competition, the Chargers defeated Jackson State 75-66, bested Roane State 74-71 in overtime, and walloped Pellissippi State 72-50 to bring home the gold and advance to the National Junior College Athletic Association (NJCAA) Division I National Championship Tournament in Hutchinson, Kansas; and

WHEREAS, Columbia State's Head Coach, Winston Neal, was honored with the Appalachian Coach of the Year Award at the NJCAA National Championship; and

WHEREAS, the following young men proudly displayed the pedigree of Chargers:

Jasiyah Suber, Alex Pollard, Kenneth Ellis, Jarrod Taylor, Arnez Anderson, Mahki Wright, Ron Brisbon, Thaddeus Johnson, Deing Wang, Julius Sisk, Emanuel Allen, Taveon Comage, Simeon Williams, Terrell Reeves, and Jamison Glass; and

WHEREAS, Columbia State's superb performance would not have been possible without the expert guidance of Coach Neal and his assistant coaches, Chris Leggett, Arthur Latham, Tony Sparkman, and Larry Jones; and

WHEREAS, the Chargers were fortunate to enjoy the unfailing support of Columbia State's President, Dr. Janet Smith; Athletic Director Katie Willingham; Vice President for Student Affairs Ruth Ann "Cissy" Holt; Student Manager Antonio Ward; and their families, fans, and community; and

WHEREAS, the members of the Columbia State men's basketball team epitomize all that is good in today's student athletes, as they have achieved a premier level of success in competition while exhibiting the highest degree of character in all aspects of life; and

WHEREAS, the perseverance, determination, work ethic, and talent of this group of young men not only made possible conference and district championships but also surely bode well for their future success; and

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly find it appropriate to acknowledge and applaud the Columbia State Chargers for their outstanding season on the hardwood; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend the coaches and members of the Columbia State Chargers men's basketball team upon an outstanding 2024-2025 season, which included two TCCAA championships, the Appalachian District championship, and a berth in the NJCAA

Division I National Championship Tournament, and extend to them our best wishes for every continued success in all their future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.